



Early Postpartum Guide

-Guiding Principles-

- Meet yourself where you are!
 - “Bouncing back” is not the name of the game
 - I encourage you to try to honor your healing after growing, carrying, and delivering a human being (and now caring for said baby earthside!)--this is no small feat for our bodies!
 - Consider your unique circumstances. No two pregnancies, births, babies, or life situations are the same. Some people push for 15 minutes while some people push for 4 hours. Some people have a village supporting them while some people are navigating much of early parenthood with few support people or resources. Some people have a colicky baby that gives them no respite while others have a contented sleeper. The variables at play are endless, so please try not to compare yourself to others too much; however, I know this is soooo hard, especially with the early postpartum hormones and emotions swirling.
- Build a foundation by beginning with the basics
 - Weeks 1-2 postpartum, primarily lying down progressing to more sitting. Weeks 3-4 postpartum, progressing to more sitting and easing into standing positions as tolerated, monitoring symptoms such as increased bleeding, pain, sensations of heaviness
 - Breathing is foundational in the early postpartum period. Our posture and positioning changes out of necessity during pregnancy and focusing on our breathing pattern early postpartum can help support returning to a more optimal posture and better function down the road
 - Main focuses:
 - Breathing into our back body
 - Breathing into our side body
 - Gentle mobility especially doing things to combat rounded shoulders and tight upper back that tend to come with lots of baby holding, feeding, rocking
 - Main focuses
 - Chest openers
 - Thoracic rotation
 - Secondary focuses as tolerated
 - Hip mobility
 - Gentle pelvic floor mobility and activation
 - Gentle core activation



- Walking progression:
 - Ease in slowly being mindful of volume
 - i.e. your total standing, activities, exertion across the day matters—if you have a day of doing more standing chores, out and about for appointments, etc. you may not *also* tolerate a focused walk
 - Monitor your symptoms and reduce activity or maintain/down progress until symptoms stabilize
 - Symptoms include increased bleeding, notable increase in pain, sensations of pelvic heaviness